

Ashish Shrestha

Documentary Filmmaker | Cinematographer | Editor

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PROFILE

Documentary filmmaker, cinematographer, and editor with eight years of professional production experience spanning festival-selected documentaries, broadcast television, and academic media. Work centers on ordinary people carrying extraordinary stories, with a focus on immigration, resilience, and community in the American South.

EDUCATION

Master of Fine Arts, Documentary Expression - 2023 to 2026

University of Mississippi, Oxford, MS

Master of Business Studies - 2018

Tribhuvan University, Kathmandu, Nepal

FILMS

Threading the American Dream

Director, Cinematographer, Editor

A 26-minute character-driven documentary about Dipa Bhattarai, a Nepali immigrant who came to the American South to pursue her undergraduate degree. She built a threading business from almost nothing, was shut down by the Mississippi State Board of Cosmetology, and fought back through a federal lawsuit that ultimately changed Mississippi law (MFA thesis film)

First Prize, Student Documentary Pitch, Riverrun International Film Festival, 2026

First Prize, Student Artistic Presentation, Auburn Southern Studies Conference, 2026

Jere Allen: A Lifetime of Passion and Resilience

Director, Cinematographer, Editor

An intimate portrait of Jere Allen, a lifelong painter, told through his life, his studio, and the work he has made across decades.

Official Selection: South Georgia Film Festival, Oxford Film Festival, Redfish Film Festival, Rising Tide Film Festival, Jackson Doc Fest.

Griot of the South

Director, Cinematographer, Editor

A short musical documentary about John Mohead, a Delta blues singer and songwriter devoted to preserving Southern music and culture.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Farm to Market

Documentary photography s

A portrait of Mr. Brown, following his journey from farm to market and his devotion to farming.

Group Exhibition, University of Mississippi, Oxford, MS

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

First Prize, Student Documentary Pitch - 2026

Riverrun International Film Festival, for Threading the American Dream

First Prize, Student Artistic Presentation - 2026

Auburn Southern Studies Conference, Auburn University at Montgomery, for Threading the American Dream

Official Selection - 2026

Nepal America International Film Festival, for Threading the American Dream

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cinematographer and Editor, Ghumante Pvt. Ltd. (April 2017 - July 2023)

Kathmandu, Nepal

- Shot and edited more than 45 travel documentaries for Ghumante's YouTube channel, managing production from pre-production through color grading.
- Produced seven short travel films for the Imagine Nepal national competition, broadcast on Kantipur TV, a national television channel of Nepal.
- Helped grow the channel's audience from 10,000 to 250,000 subscribers.
- Developed a consistent visual style across documentary and promotional content.

Graduate Assistant, Center for the Study of Southern Culture (Aug 2024 - May 2026)

University of Mississippi, Oxford, MS

- Record, edit, and publish SouthTalks lecture events for the Center's public YouTube channel.
- Manage multi-camera setup, audio capture, and post-production for recurring public programming.

Media Production Intern, NP Films (Aug 2024 - May 2025)

Dallas, Texas

- Assisted with camera placement, composition, and multi-camera coordination on set.
- Edited post-production content for event and commercial clients.

Graduate Assistant, Archives and Special Collections, (Aug 2023 - May 2024)

University of Mississippi Libraries, Oxford, MS

- Supported the archivist in shelving, cataloging, and preserving books, audio cassettes, video cassettes, posters, and other archival material.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cinematography: Panasonic EVA1, Blackmagic 6K Pro, Sony A7III and FX3, DSLR; gimbals, sliders, drone operation

Editing and Color: Adobe Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Adobe After Effects

Audio: Lavalier and wireless systems, Zoom H6, boom pole, sound mixing

Lighting: Three-point setups, practicals, location lighting

Photography: Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Photoshop

AI Production Tools: Runway, Sora

Languages: English (fluent), Nepali (native), Hindi (conversational)